

AI Readiness Checklist

Company: [COMPANY NAME]

Checklist owner: [AI GOVERNANCE LEAD]

Date started:

Target first-pass completion date:

How to use. Use this checklist to turn the starter kit into a practical first-pass governance file. Do not wait for perfection. The goal is to make AI use visible, assign ownership, set basic rules, and identify the higher-risk items that need deeper review.

Status key

Use the same status labels across the checklist:

- Not started - no owner or draft exists
- Drafted - first draft exists but has not been reviewed
- In use - adopted for the team and available to users
- Needs review - requires legal, privacy, security, procurement, or leadership review
- Done enough for first pass - complete enough to operate while improving over time

1. Inventory and ownership

Item	Status	Owner	Evidence / link	Next action
List every AI tool already used for work				
Include personal accounts used for business work				
Assign a business owner for each tool or workflow				
Mark which tools are approved, under review, or not approved				
Set the next review date for each active tool				

First-pass target: every known AI tool has an owner, approval status, and next review date.

2. Data handling and approved tools

Item	Status	Owner	Evidence / link	Next action
Define which AI tools are approved for work use				
Write rules for public,				

internal, confidential, customer, employee, student, health, financial, legal, and regulated data				
Confirm whether approved tools use prompts or uploads for model training				
Turn off training/use-for-improvement settings where available and appropriate				
Document who can approve exceptions				

First-pass target: staff know which data is allowed, restricted, or prohibited for AI tools.

3. Human review and output use

Item	Status	Owner	Evidence / link	Next action
Define when AI output must be reviewed by a person before use				
Identify use cases where AI output may not be used as-is				
Require source checking for factual, legal, financial, medical, employment, or customer-facing content				
Define who approves high-visibility external use				
Document escalation path for uncertain outputs				

First-pass target: no one treats AI output as automatically correct for important work.

4. New tool and workflow review

Item	Status	Owner	Evidence / link	Next action
Require the AI Risk Intake and Impact				

Assessment before adopting new higher-risk AI use				
Use the AI Tool Approval Mini-Checklist for simple low-risk tool requests				
Define stop-and-escalate triggers for sensitive data, customer-facing use, or decisions about people				
Record approval conditions in the inventory				
Set a review date after approval				

First-pass target: new AI use does not spread without a review path.

5. Staff rollout

Item	Status	Owner	Evidence / link	Next action
Send the Team Rollout Message to affected staff				
Publish the approved tools list and AI use rules where staff can find them				
Collect acknowledgments if required by your organization				
Tell staff where to ask questions or report concerns				
Schedule a follow-up after the first 30 days				

First-pass target: staff know the rules, the approved tools, and the question path.

6. Higher-risk workflows

Flag any workflow that touches one or more of the following:

- Employment, hiring, promotion, discipline, or termination
- Credit, lending, insurance, pricing, eligibility, or benefits
- Housing, education, healthcare, legal services, or government services

- Children, students, patients, employees, applicants, or vulnerable people
- Customer-facing chatbot or automated communication
- Sensitive personal data, biometric data, health data, financial data, or regulated records
- Safety, cybersecurity, production systems, or autonomous tool use

Workflow	Why it is higher risk	Owner	Current status	Next review step

First-pass target: higher-risk workflows are visible and routed for deeper review before launch or expansion.

7. Update rhythm

Item	Status	Owner	Evidence / link	Next action
Start the AI Update Tracker				
Log material changes to tools, vendors, prompts, models, workflows, and policies				
Schedule quarterly review of the inventory and policy				
Define who watches vendor notices and regulatory updates				
Keep retired tools in the inventory for recordkeeping				

First-pass target: changes do not happen only in memory or chat threads.

8. First-pass completion check

Mark the packet done enough for first pass when all of these are true:

- ☐ Active AI tools are listed in the inventory
- ☐ Each active AI tool has an owner
- ☐ Approved and unapproved tools are distinguishable
- ☐ Staff-facing AI use rules exist
- ☐ Sensitive-data rules are written down
- ☐ New AI tool requests have an intake path
- ☐ Higher-risk workflows are flagged for review
- ☐ An update tracker is started
- ☐ Staff know where to ask AI use questions

Disclaimer

This document is a template for educational and informational purposes only. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Consult qualified counsel before relying on this checklist for compliance decisions.